

World's smallest battery from Center for Integrated Nanotechnologies

pared to one using bulky electrodes. Researchers developed this battery in order to better understand the mechanism in which it works and formed the battery inside a transmission electron microscope that would enable them to study charging and discharging of the battery in real time and at atomic-scale resolution.

The researchers found that while charging, the tin-oxide nanowire rod almost doubled in length. This was greater than the diameter increase and could result in avoiding short circuits that often reduce battery life.

The CINT is a Department of Energy research facility jointly operated by Sandia and Los Alamos national laboratories.

Turn your iPhone into a universal remote

A small company called Peel has come out with a universal control system that puts your iPhone or iPod touch at par with universal remotes like Logitech's Harmony system.

Instead of attaching a dongle to the iPhone itself, the system controls your AV rack using a pear-sized wireless IR

blaster that rests quietly on your coffee table. The blaster (called the Peel Fruit) connects over ZigBee to a tiny network adaptor (the Peel cable) that attaches directly to an open Ethernet port on your WiFi router—a two-part hardware setup that is designed to obviate the need for software configuration during installation, and allows the IR blaster to run for nine months on a single battery.

Control home appliances from your office

Infosys Technologies has created a new platform called 'Digital Smart Home Gateway' to carry out several tasks remotely. Based on the Intel Atom E600 chip, it links multiple home devices, allowing consumers to control home electronic and electrical gadgets from their office using a Wi-Fi console, smartphone or remotely via the Web.

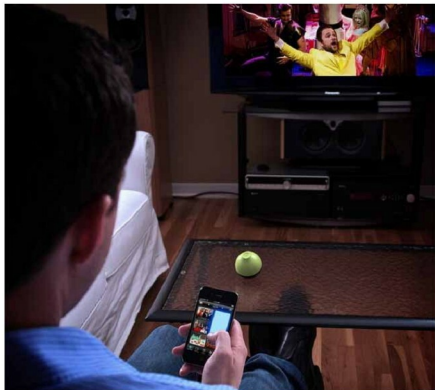
The solution comes loaded with built-in wireless technologies (like Zigbee, Bluetooth and WiFi) and runs on Meego—a Linux-based open source mobile operating system. It also allows you to monitor energy consumption per appliance.

Wallets that warn you are running out of cash

It's now easy to keep track of how much you are spending. A researcher has come up with a set of smart wallets that tell you when you are low on cash. One of the wallets shrinks when your bank balance is low, in an effort to discourage you from spending. Another has a hinge which becomes tighter and tighter to open when you have less money, while the third vibrates every time you use it.

All three wallets have a built-in tiny computer and connect to the user's mobile phone using Bluetooth, which then connects to the user's bank account information on the Internet. This means that the wallet is constantly updated with how much money the user has in his account, and can act accordingly.

The wallets have been developed



Peel iPhone remote